Unit 6

HEALTH ASSESSMENT AND PHYSICAL EXAMINATION

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

At the end of this chapter students will be able to:

1. Define physical examination
2. List out the purposes of physical examination
3. Enumerate the methods of physical examination
4. State the principles of physical examination
5. Demonstrate the procedure of taking temperature
6. Discuss the assessment of pulse
7. Explain the purposes of blood pressure recording
8. Brief the pain assessment procedure
9. Demonstrate the urine testing procedure

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6.1 INTRODUCTION

A complete health assessment also includes gathering information about a person's medical history and lifestyle, doing laboratory tests, and screening for disease. A physical examination is an evaluation of the body and its functions using inspection, palpation (feeling with the hands), percussion (tapping with the fingers) auscultation (listening).

6.2 DEFINITION

Health assessment involves collecting, validating and analyzing data about thepatient health. It includes gathering both subjective and objective data.

6.3 PURPOSES OF PHYSICAL EXAMINATION

- To gather the information for each health history component.
- To supplement confirm or repute data obtained in the nursing history.
- To confirm and identify nursing diagnoses.
- To make clinical judgment about a clients.
- Changing health status and management.
- To evaluate the physiological outcome.

"From the bitterness of disease, man learns the sweetness of health."

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